

Court No. - 21

Case :- WRIT - C No. - 10133 of 2018

Petitioner :- Prahlad Singh

Respondent :- State Of U.P. And Another

Counsel for Petitioner :- Ravindra Kumar

Counsel for Respondent :- C.S.C.,Baleshwar Chaturvedi

Hon'ble Krishna Murari,J.

Hon'ble Ajay Bhanot,J.

Heard learned counsel for the petitioner and Sri Baleshwar Chaturvedi, learned counsel for respondent no. 2.

By means of this petition filed under Article 226 of the Constitution of India, the petitioner has challenged the demand notice dated 08.01.2018 of Rs.2,25,688/- issued in his name.

It is contended on behalf of the petitioner that since he did not receive the copy of the provisional assessment notice, as such, he could not submit his reply and in absence whereof the respondent treated it to be final and issued recovery certificate. Learned counsel for the petitioner states that the petitioner will submit objection to the provisional assessment within two weeks from today. Learned counsel appearing for the petitioner has also invited our attention towards the provisions contained under Clause 6.8(b)(1) of the U.P. Electricity Supply Code, 2005. The argument is that the respondent-corporation while issuing the provisional assessment notice was required to fix a date in the notice itself for hearing so that the consumer could appear before the authority concerned on the date so specified.

From the perusal of the provisional assessment order, it does not appear that any date was indicated in the notice for hearing in the matter and, in such circumstances, the contention of the petitioner that notice itself was not in accordance with the requirement of law, appears to have substance.

This Court in **Ashok Kumar and others Vs. State of U.P. & Ors., 2008(6) ADJ 660 (DB)** from paras 56 to 64 has considered the provisions of the Electricity Supply Code 2005, to be followed in a case of theft of electricity for assessment.

In the present case, we find that provisional assessment notice does not give the basis on which petitioner was assessed to pay Rs.2,25,688/-. The notice also does not specify the date and time for hearing, which was required under the Code.

In view of the fact that notice for provisional assessment

issued to the petitioner itself was not in accordance with law, we are of the opinion that petitioner was not afforded adequate opportunity as provided in para 6.8(b) of U.P. Electricity Code, 2005.

Consequently, the writ petition is allowed. The impugned demand notice dated 08.01.2018 is hereby quashed. The final assessment order shall be made within six weeks after considering petitioner's objection, giving reasons to meet the objections of petitioner in the light of observations made in **Ashok Kumar** (supra).

Order Date :- 20.3.2018

VKS